Achievement EHCP TARGET progression mapping

Composition Strand Overview

The composition strand focuses on developing pupils' understanding of how numbers are made and how they can be broken apart and recombined. It begins with practical experiences of joining and separating groups, before progressing to recognising that numbers consist of smaller parts. Pupils then use this understanding to solve addition and subtraction problems and, eventually, to recognise and apply structured number relationships such as number bonds. This strand supports pupils in moving from physically manipulating quantities to understanding and using the structure of number.

Why is it important?

It is the foundation for addition, subtraction, number bonds, mental maths.

Without it - pupils rely on counting for everything

With it - pupils begin to think mathematically about number structure

Pathway Aim

By the end of the pathway, pupils will be able to understand how numbers are composed and decomposed, and use this knowledge to represent, manipulate and solve addition and subtraction problems in a range of practical contexts.

Example Evidence Statements

""The pupil can combine two groups and recognise that the total has increased."
"They can partition 5 into two parts and show it in more than one way."
"They use objects to solve simple addition problems and explain what they have done."
"They recall some number bonds and use part–whole models to represent numbers."

Combining & Separating (Bands 3–4)	**Part–Whole Awareness (Band 5)**	**Additive Reasoning (Band 6)**	**Structured Number Understanding (Band 7)**
Pupils explore how quantities can be combined and separated through practical action. They experience adding and taking away but are not yet working with formal number understanding.	Pupils begin to understand that numbers are made of parts. They can split numbers into smaller amounts and recognise that the same total can be represented in different ways.	Pupils use their understanding of combining and separating to represent and solve simple addition and subtraction problems using practical and visual methods.	Pupils develop a secure understanding of number structure using part–part–whole relationships and begin to recall key number facts and explain how

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			numbers are composed and decomposed.
Key stage Target By the end of the key stage, the pupil will combine and separate groups of objects and recognise that quantity changes as a result.	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will understand that numbers can be broken into smaller parts and represented in different ways.	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will use knowledge of combining and separating to solve simple addition and subtraction problems using practical resources.	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will use part–part–whole understanding and number bonds to represent and solve number problems.
Typical evidence might include: • attending to counting sequences • anticipating the next item/action joining in with songs, rhymes or repeated patterns • tracking objects as they are counted	**Typical evidence might include:** • saying numbers in order (with or without support) • joining in with familiar counting routines • filling in missing numbers in a sequence • reciting number sequences during play	**Typical evidence might include:** • touching or moving each object when counting • counting objects accurately in small sets • stopping at the correct number • recounting to check	**Typical evidence might include:** • counting forwards from a given number • counting backwards • counting objects in different arrangements • recognising number patterns
Mapped curriculum targets **Band 3** • I can combine small groups and notice there are more • I can begin to match one object to another **Band 4** • I can combine groups • I can separate groups and notice changes • I can join and separate objects with support	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 5** • I can recognise numbers are made of parts • I can partition numbers within 5 • I can combine and separate numbers • I can show numbers in different ways	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 6** • I can partition numbers within 10 • I can add and subtract 1 • I can record using marks • I can represent addition and subtraction using objects	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 7** • I can use part–part–whole models • I can recall some number bonds • I can solve simple problems • I can explain how numbers are composed and decomposed

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Next Step: Develop understanding that numbers can be broken into parts (Part–Whole Awareness)	**Next Step:** Use part–whole understanding to solve simple addition and subtraction problems (Additive Reasoning)	**Next Step:** Develop a structured understanding of number using number bonds and part–part–whole relationships (Structured Number Understanding)	**Next Step:** Apply structured understanding of number to support learning in addition and subtraction, place value, multiplication and division, and fractions